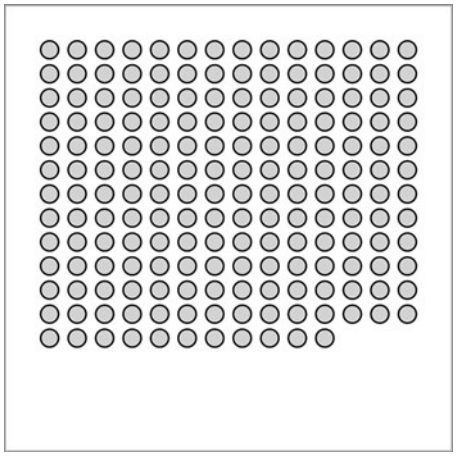


Figure 10.6 The countries of the world as a grid

10.2.1 Loading sample data

Instead of the tweets.json data, we'll use world.geojson, except we'll use the features as datapoints on our custom grid layout from section 10.1 without putting them on a map. Listing 10.10 shows the corresponding code, which produces figure 10.6. You may find it strange to load geodata and represent it not as geographic shapes but in an entirely different way. Presenting data in an untraditional manner can often be a useful technique to draw a user's attention to the patterns in that data.

Listing 10.10 Loading the countries of the world into a grid

```
d3.json("world.geojson ", function(error, data) {
    makeAGrid(data);
  })

function makeAGrid(data) {
  var grid = d3.layout.grid();
  grid.size([300,300]);
  var griddedData = grid(data.features);

  griddedData.forEach(function (country) {
    country.size = d3.geo.area(country);
  });

  d3.select("svg")
    .append("g")
    .attr("transform", "translate(50,50)")
    .selectAll("circle")
    .data(griddedData)
    .enter()
    .append("circle")
    .attr("cx", function(d) {return d.x})
    .attr("cy", function(d) {return d.y})
    .attr("r", 10)
    .style("fill", "lightgray")
```

Calculates the area of each country and appends that to the datapoint

Appends a circle for each country